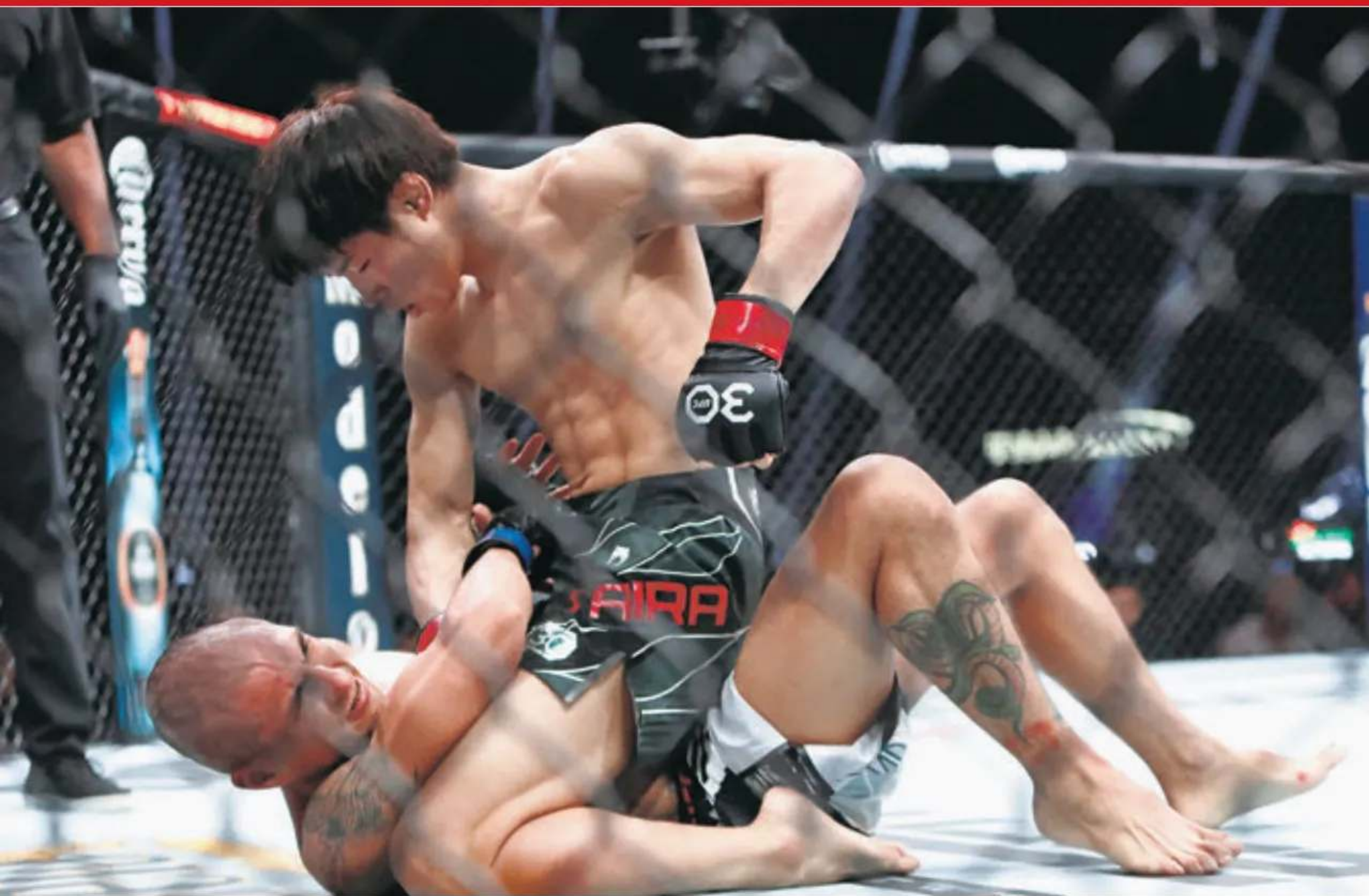




The setback snapped his six-fight run of first-round finishes but did little to diminish his standing in the heavyweight ranks, as he troubled Aspinall in the early moments of the bout and remains one of the most feared knockout threats in the division.

Volkov, 35, has evolved since his loss to Aspinall back in March 2022, winning three straight stoppage fights to reclaim title contention.

Volkov used strikes to defeat Jairzinho Rozenstruik and Alexandr Romanov in the first round before showcasing his submission skills in the second round, ending Tai Tuivasa with an Ezekiel choke.

Taira continues his dream

The main event

fight between Tatsuro Taira and Alex Perez on June 16 ended unexpectedly, with the former collecting a second-round stoppage win when Perez suffered a knee injury after being forced into the canvas.

Following a tight first round and the initial part of the second, Taira launched a takedown, quickly gaining the upper hand, locking in the body triangle, and attempting to find a chokehold.

Halfway through the second round, the undefeated 24-year-old tripped Perez, and as the former title challenger fell to the canvas, something in his knee popped, bringing the fight to an immediate halt.

The promising standout from Okinawa now has six

Rising star: Tatsuro Taira now has six straight wins in the UFC and 16 victories overall, continuing to establish himself as one of the best emerging talents. AFP

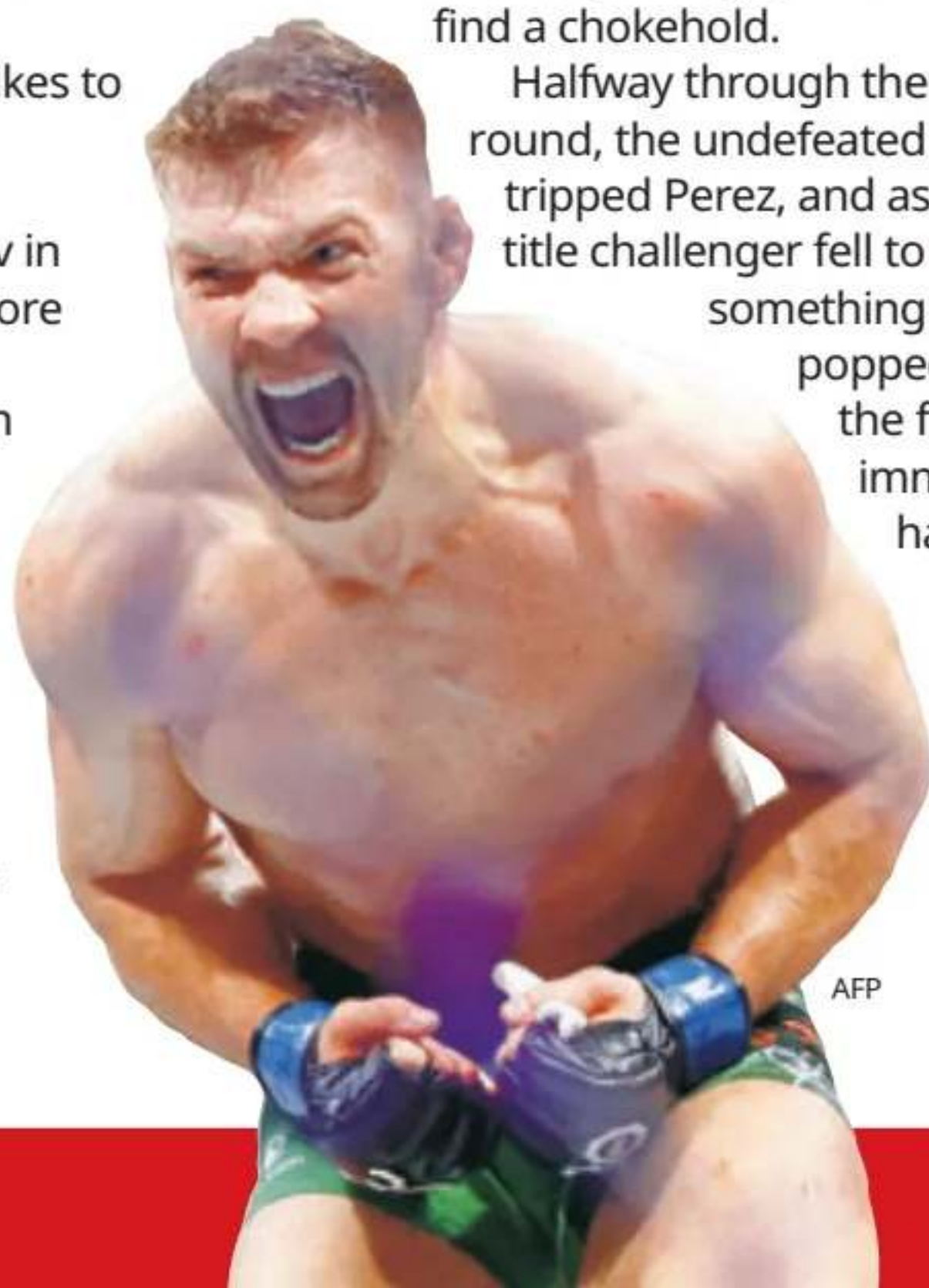
straight wins in the UFC and 16 victories overall, continuing to establish himself as one of the best emerging talents.

Du Plessis vs Adesanya, finally!

UFC CEO Dana White confirmed that the middleweight title will be on the line at UFC 305 in Perth, Australia, when champion Dricus Du Plessis (left) takes on former champion Israel Adesanya. The fight is scheduled to take place on August 17.

Du Plessis will make his first defence of the title after claiming the belt from Sean Strickland at UFC 297 in Toronto last January.

Adesanya will attempt to become the first fighter since Randy Couture to own three separate title reigns in the same division.



AFP